IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 2

House and Home

Describing where you live and choosing accommodation

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 2 · Book pp. 20–33

LEARNING GOAL

Describe a home and choose the right accommodation in speech and writing

Objectives: you will...

- name rooms, places and items in a home
- use the present simple with be, other verbs and can
- put adverbs of frequency in the right place
- take notes by comparing two texts
- answer listening questions within a word limit
- write an email to a friend
- speak about choosing accommodation

Success criteria: I can...

- use the right word for rooms and household items
- make questions and negatives with be, do / does and can
- put always, usually and never in the right place
- notice when a second text changes information
- keep to the word limit and spell names correctly
- use capital letters and question marks in an email
- give a reason for my choice

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

READING

Compare the texts. Check what one text (an email) says about the information in another (an advert).

More options than questions? Read them all and choose the best one.

Tip 9, p. 23 · box, p. 26

LISTENING

Listen to all the information before you choose your answer.

Listen for the exact name, how many options, and numbers.

Tip 7, p. 22 · Mini tips 13.1–13.3, p. 25

READING AND LISTENING

Keep to the word limit. If the task says two or three words, do not write more or fewer.

Box, p. 22

LEAD-IN

Draw a plan of your home in 60 seconds

1 · Draw

Draw the rooms. Write the name of each room in English.

2 · Show

Show a partner. “This is the kitchen. It’s next to…”

3 · Ask

Which room do you use most? Which room don’t you have?

VOCABULARY

Rooms and places in and around a home

Room or place	What happens there?
hallway / hall	You walk through it from the front door to the other rooms.
study	A quiet room for reading, working or homework.
attic	The space at the top of the house, under the roof.
basement	The floor under the house, below the ground.
garage	Where you keep the car (and often bikes).

Up or down? The *attic* is at the top; the *basement* is under the ground. Many students mix them up.

VOCABULARY

Items in a home: what's the difference?

fridge / freezer

A fridge keeps food cold. A freezer keeps it frozen.

curtains / blinds

Both cover a window: curtains are cloth; blinds have strips.

sink / bath

Wash your hands in a sink. Lie down in a bath.

wardrobe / drawers

Hang clothes in a wardrobe. Fold them into drawers.

house / flat

A flat (apartment) is one home on one floor of a building.

Types of house

detached: alone · **semi-detached**: joined to one · **terraced**: in a row

GRAMMAR · FORM AND USE

Present simple: three kinds of verb

	be	other verbs	can
+	The flat is small.	She lives in a flat.	I can cook.
–	The flat isn’t small.	She doesn’t live in a flat.	I can’t cook.
?	Is the flat small?	Does she live in a flat?	Can you cook?
Wh-?	Where is the flat?	Where does she live?	What can you cook?

The rule: *be* and *can* change places to make a question. Other verbs need *do / does*.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

Wrong	Right	Why?
Do you are a student?	Are you a student?	be: no do
Do you can swim?	Can you swim?	can: no do
She don’t like her room.	She doesn’t like her room.	she → does
Does he lives with you?	Does he live with you?	does + base verb
Where the bathroom is?	Where is the bathroom?	word order

Check two things: Is the main verb *be* or *can*? Is the subject *he / she / it*?

GRAMMAR · ADVERBS OF FREQUENCY

Where does the adverb go?

With be: after the verb

My room **is** **always** tidy.

I **am** **never** late for dinner.

Other verbs: before the verb

We **usually** **eat** in the kitchen.

She **sometimes** **studies** in the garden.

always 100% | usually | often | sometimes | rarely | never 0%

READING SKILL

Note taking from two texts

1

Read the notes

What information do you need? A name, a price, a day?

2

Find it in text 1

Underline it in the advert.

3

Check text 2

Does the email change it? Look for *not*, *now*, *a mistake*.

4

Write the newest

Use the correct, updated information.

IELTS STRATEGY

Compare the information in one text with the information in the other. The second text may correct the first.

READING PRACTICE

An advert, a message and your notes

Advert · Green Park Rooms

Quiet rooms near the station. £80 a week. Kitchen shared with two students. Free parking. Call Tom Reid, Monday to Thursday.

Message from Ana

I lived there last year! Tom now works on Fridays too. The rooms are £85 now, not £80. Parking isn’t free any more, but the bus stop is outside.

Your notes

1 Price per week: _____ 2 Call Tom: Monday to _____ 3 Parking: free? _____ 4 Shared room: _____

READING · DIALOGUE BUILDING

Choose the best sentence

Agent: Hello, City Rooms. How can I help?

Student: Hi. _____ a room near the university?

A Do you have

B Have you got do

C Are you have

IELTS STRATEGY

Sometimes there are **more options than questions**. Read every option and choose the **best** one, not the first one that looks possible.

LISTENING 1

Pictures and short answers

Choosing a picture

Before you listen, find what is **different** in each picture: the window, the bed, the TV.

IELTS STRATEGY

Listen carefully to **all** the information before you choose. The speaker may say “not”, or change the information.

Short answers

“Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS.”

Answer	OK?
a desk	Yes: 2 words
a big desk	No: 3 words
big desk	Yes: 2 words

IELTS STRATEGY

Do not write more or fewer words than the task asks for.

LISTENING 2

A phone call: what do they talk about?

Yes or no? Do they discuss…

1 the student’s course?

2 how many rooms are free?

3 the price of the room?

4 the student’s favourite food?

IELTS STRATEGY

Listen for:

- the **exact** name of a course
- **how many** options there are
- **numbers**

WRITING

An email to a friend

1
Greeting
Hi Ben,

2
Thank
Thanks for your email.

3
Answer
Answer all their questions.

4
Ask
Ask your own questions.

5
Closing
Write soon, + name

Capital letters

I · names (**B**en, **L**ondon) · the first word of every sentence

Punctuation

Full stop **.** after a sentence · question mark **?** after a question · comma **,** after Hi Ben

WRITING · MODEL

A reply in 70 words

Hi Lucy,

Thanks for your email. I live in a small flat with my aunt. There is a big park near our flat. My bedroom is next to the kitchen. It has a desk, a wardrobe and blue curtains. I **usually** study at my desk **because** it is quiet, **but** the window is very small. **Do you like your new room? Is it near your college?**

Write soon,
Mai

Greeting and closing on their own lines

Adverb, reason, contrast

Two questions with question marks

SPEAKING · IELTS PART 1

Talking about your home

Make it longer

Answer: I live in an apartment.

Describe: It’s on the 12th floor and it has three bedrooms.

Reason: I like it because the view is amazing.

Do you live in a house or an apartment?

Which room do you spend the most time in? Why?

What do you usually do at home at the weekend?

Is there anything you would like to change about your home?

SPEAKING

Choosing accommodation

	Room A: in town	Room B: near the sea
Travel	5 minutes on foot	40 minutes by bus
Room	small, shared bathroom	big, private bathroom
People	8 other students	a family with two children
Meals	not included	breakfast and dinner

I’d prefer Room ___ **because** ___.

Room A is ___, **but** Room B is ___.

PAIR PRACTICE

Phone the accommodation office

Student

Ask 4 questions: price, bathroom, travel, meals.

Officer

Answer from Room A or B. Change one fact: “No, sorry…”

Then

Write 4 short notes (two words each). Swap roles.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- Name 10 rooms, places and items in a home
- Make questions with be, do / does and can
- Put always, usually, never in the right place
- Check a second text for newer information
- Answer in no more than two words
- Write an email with capitals and question marks

Next: take the *Unit 2 Challenge* on Miss L Gems and submit your PDF on Google Classroom.